

TUTORIAL

Crochet Granny Square: Complete Beginner Tutorial

The exact stitches for your first granny square, written in US terms, from magic ring to finished square.

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The granny square is one of the most-recognised crochet patterns for a reason: it only uses chain and double crochet, works in rounds without any tricky shaping, and teaches colour-changing and corner construction all in one small project. This tutorial covers three rounds, enough for a coaster or the start of a blanket square.

What you need

- A 5.0mm hook (see our [hook buying guide](#) if you don't have one)
- Worsted-weight yarn in one or more colours
- Scissors and a yarn needle for weaving in ends

Round 1: the centre

Steps

1. Chain 4, then join into a ring with a slip stitch into the first chain.

2. Chain 3 (this counts as your first double crochet).
3. Work 2 more double crochet into the ring.
4. Chain 2 (this forms the corner).
5. Work [3 double crochet, chain 2] into the ring three more times — you'll have 4 groups of 3 double crochet, each separated by a chain-2 corner.
6. Join with a slip stitch to the top of your starting chain-3. Fasten off if changing colour, or continue to Round 2.

Round 2: building the square

Steps

1. Join your yarn (new colour or same) into any chain-2 corner space.
2. Chain 3, then work [2 double crochet, chain 2, 3 double crochet] into that same corner space — this makes the corner.
3. Chain 1, then work 3 double crochet into the next chain-2 space (this is now a side, not a corner).
4. Repeat: corner in each corner space, chain 1 and 3 double crochet in each side space, going around all 4 sides.
5. Join with a slip stitch to the top of your starting chain-3.

Round 3: repeat the pattern

Steps

Round 3 repeats the same logic as Round 2, just with one more side section per edge:

1. Join into any corner space, chain 3, then [2 double crochet, chain 2, 3 double crochet] in that corner.
2. Chain 1, 3 double crochet in the next space, chain 1, 3 double crochet in the next space (two side groups now, instead of one).
3. Repeat around all 4 sides, then join with a slip stitch to close the round.

Every additional round follows this same pattern: a corner group in each corner, and one more side group per edge than the round before.

Finishing and joining squares

Fasten off and weave in your ends with a yarn needle. For a single coaster, you're done. To make a blanket, crochet multiple squares to the same round count, then join them either by whip stitching the edges together with a yarn needle, or by single crocheting them together as a border — whip stitching is the simpler option for a first attempt.

Frequently asked questions

How many rounds does a basic granny square have?

A basic granny square is often worked to 3 or 4 rounds for a coaster-sized square, roughly 4 to 5 inches across. You can keep adding rounds to make it as large as you like for a blanket.

Do I need to change yarn colour for each round of a granny square?

No, colour changes are a style choice, not a requirement. A granny square made in a single colour throughout is just as structurally correct as a multicoloured one.

How do I join granny squares together into a blanket?

The two most common methods are whip stitching the edges together with a yarn needle, or single crocheting the squares together as a border. Whip stitching is

simpler for a first attempt; single crochet joining gives a neater, more finished edge.

Written by Emily Hartwell

Emily has been crocheting for over a decade, ever since her grandmother taught her the basics one summer. She started CrochetGuides to write the clear, honest, beginner-friendly instructions she wishes she'd had when she was learning — the ones that actually work the first time.